

FASS

Technologies LLC

Fill Any Shift or Service.

Government Contracting Masterclass Workbook

10 Nights · 2 Weeks · From Registration to First Contract

INSTRUCTOR

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WHAT YOU WILL HAVE WHEN THIS IS DONE

- Active SAM.gov registration with UEI
- eMMA vendor profile with set-asides
- Professional capabilities statement
- Your NAICS codes selected and registered
- MBE application in progress
- A completed solicitation response draft
- A 90-day contract pursuit plan

This workbook is your operating manual. Every session builds on the last. Do the homework. Show up with your work.

How to Use This Workbook

Each night covers one critical piece of the government contracting process. The sessions are sequenced — Night 2 assumes you completed Night 1's homework. Night 6 assumes your SAM.gov registration is in progress.

Do not come to class just to listen. Come with your documents, your questions, and your completed homework. The people who leave this course with a contract are the ones who did the work in between sessions.

THE FIVE RULES OF THIS CLASS

1. Do the homework. Every session has one specific action item. It is not optional.
2. Bring your real business. We are not building hypothetical companies. We are building yours.
3. Ask the hard questions. If something does not make sense or does not apply to your situation, say so.
4. Do not claim what you cannot verify. Everything you put in a proposal must be true and documentable.
5. Execute after class. The masterclass is the knowledge. The contract comes from the action.

WEEK 1 — FOUNDATION

Night 1 — The Opportunity: understanding the government market
Night 2 — Entity Setup: SAM.gov, eMMA, and your federal identity
Night 3 — NAICS Codes and Certifications: unlocking set-asides
Night 4 — Capabilities Statement: building the document that gets you in the room
Night 5 — Workshop: peer review and final polish

WEEK 2 — EXECUTION

Night 6 — Reading a Solicitation: extracting everything that matters
Night 7 — Bid / No-Bid: the decision that saves you from losing before you start
Night 8 — Pricing: building a number that wins without losing money
Night 9 — Writing the Response: telling your story in the agency's language
Night 10 — After the Award: performing, documenting, and compounding

WEEK ONE — FOUNDATION

NIGHT

1

The Opportunity — Why Government Is Your Biggest Untapped Customer

Week 1 · Understanding the market before you build anything

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Understand how much federal, state, and local government spends with small businesses every year
- Learn why most small businesses never access this market — and why that is your advantage
- Identify which level of government is easiest to start with based on your business type
- Leave with one specific agency to research before Night 2

The size of the market

The federal government is the largest buyer of goods and services in the world. Maryland state government and Baltimore City together spend billions annually on contracts — a significant portion reserved by law for small businesses. Most of that money goes to companies that simply showed up and knew the process.

Why small businesses leave it on the table

No awareness that the opportunity exists. No registered presence in the procurement system. No professional-looking capability documentation. No disciplined process for finding and responding to solicitations. None of these are skill barriers — they are knowledge and process barriers. That is exactly what this course removes.

Three levels: federal, state, local

SAM.gov is the federal marketplace. eMMA is Maryland's state procurement portal. Baltimore City and county governments post separately. You do not need all three on Day 1. You need the one that matches your services and is closest to your current capacity.

The small business set-aside advantage

By law, federal agencies must direct a percentage of contract spending to small businesses. Maryland runs a Small Business Reserve program that restricts certain contracts to small businesses only. As a small business, you are not competing against Lockheed Martin. You are competing against people who also do not know what they are doing yet — and FASS does.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Go to sam.gov/content/opportunities. Search your type of work — cleaning, staffing, food service, event support, logistics. Read three opportunity titles and their descriptions. Write down what you notice.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 1

- ✓ Government is the largest buyer in the country and is required by law to spend with small businesses
- ✓ The barrier is not skill — it is knowledge, registration, and process
- ✓ Maryland's eMMA and Baltimore City are the fastest entry points for most local service businesses
- ✓ Your first target is one agency, one contract type, one NAICS code

NOTES

Entity Setup — SAM.gov, eMMA, and Your Federal Identity

Week 1 · Getting your business into the procurement system

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Understand what a UEI is and why it is the foundation of everything
- Walk through the SAM.gov registration process step by step
- Register or begin registration on Maryland's eMMA portal
- Know exactly what documents and information you need before you start

What is a UEI

The Unique Entity Identifier is a 12-character code assigned by SAM.gov that serves as your federal business ID. Without it, you cannot be awarded a federal contract, cannot receive federal grant funding, and cannot appear in any federal procurement search. Getting your UEI assigned is free and takes less than an hour. Completing the full registration takes 45–90 minutes and activates within 7–10 business days.

What you need before you start SAM.gov

Your EIN from the IRS. Your legal business name exactly as registered with your state. Your physical business address. Your NAICS codes — the industry classification codes that determine what opportunities you see. A bank account and routing number for payment setup. Your SDAT number if you are a Maryland LLC. Have all of these in front of you before you click 'Add New Entity.'

Walking through eMMA registration

eMMA is Maryland's eMaryland Marketplace Advantage portal at emma.maryland.gov. Registration is free. You create a vendor profile, select your service categories, set your service area, and receive automatic notifications when matching opportunities are posted. The Small Business Reserve self-certification is completed in the same portal — it takes 20 minutes and immediately places you in a smaller, less competitive bidding pool.

NAICS codes — your opportunity filter

NAICS codes are six-digit industry classification codes. The codes you register under in SAM.gov and eMMA determine which opportunities you see and which set-asides you qualify for. Core FASS codes: 561320 Temporary Help Services, 561210 Facilities Support Services, 561720 Janitorial Services, 561499 All Other Business Support Services. Register all codes that accurately describe your work — not codes you cannot support.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Complete or begin your SAM.gov registration. If already registered, log in and verify your NAICS codes are correct. Screenshot your entity status page and bring it to Night 3.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 2

- ✓ UEI is your federal identity — free to get, required for everything
- ✓ SAM.gov registration takes 45–90 minutes and activates in 7–10 days
- ✓ eMMA is Maryland's portal — register here for state and local opportunities
- ✓ NAICS codes are your opportunity filter — choose every code that matches your real work

NOTES

NAICS Codes & Certifications — Unlocking Set-Asides and Preferences

Week 1 · Certifications that open doors no general vendor can enter

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Select the right NAICS codes for your specific business
- Understand the difference between federal and state small business programs
- Learn what MBE certification is and why it is a force multiplier in Maryland
- Know which certifications to pursue first based on your timeline

Small Business Reserve — Maryland's fastest win

Maryland's Small Business Reserve program restricts certain state procurements to small businesses only. Self-certification is free, takes 20 minutes inside eMMA, and immediately places you in a smaller bidding pool where your only competition is other small businesses. This is the first certification every Maryland small business should complete.

MBE certification — the subcontracting door

Maryland's Minority Business Enterprise certification through MDOT opens subcontracting opportunities on virtually every major state contract. Prime contractors who win large Maryland contracts are required to meet MBE participation goals — meaning they must hire certified MBE subs. Even before you win a prime contract, MBE certification gets you paid as a subcontractor on contracts you did not have to bid on directly. The application requires ownership documentation, financials, and a site visit for some categories.

Federal small business certifications

SBA offers several certification programs: 8(a) Business Development for socially and economically disadvantaged businesses, HUBZone for businesses in historically underutilized areas, WOSB for women-owned small businesses, and SDVOSB for service-disabled veteran-owned businesses. Each unlocks specific set-asides at the federal level. Research which apply to your ownership profile.

Certification strategy — sequence matters

Do not try to get every certification at once. The sequence: SAM.gov registration first, eMMA Small Business Reserve self-certification second, MBE application third if you qualify, federal SBA certifications fourth based on ownership profile. Each one builds on the last and expands the pool of opportunities you can access.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Research your MBE eligibility at mdot.maryland.gov/MBE. Download the application checklist. List the three documents you do not have yet and need to gather.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 3

- ✓ Maryland Small Business Reserve self-certification is free and takes 20 minutes — do it today
- ✓ MBE certification opens subcontracting income before you ever win a prime contract
- ✓ Sequence your certifications: SAM → eMMA SBR → MBE → SBA programs
- ✓ Certifications are not just credentials — they are legal set-asides that reduce your competition

NOTES

Your Capabilities Statement — The Document That Gets You in the Room

Week 1 · Building the one-page document every contracting officer expects

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Understand what a capabilities statement is and when to use it
- Know every section a professional capabilities statement must include
- Begin building your own capabilities statement during class
- Leave with a complete draft ready for review

What a capabilities statement is

A capabilities statement is a one-to-two page professional document that summarizes your business for a contracting officer, prime contractor, or agency small business liaison. It is not a resume. It is not a brochure. It is a structured document that answers three questions: Who are you, what can you do, and why should we trust you to do it. Every agency small business office expects to receive one. Prime contractors ask for one before they discuss teaming or subcontracting.

The six required sections

Every capabilities statement must have: your company profile (name, UEI, CAGE when assigned, address, contact), your NAICS codes and set-aside status, your core competencies and service lines, your differentiators (what makes you different from every other small business in your category), your past performance or relevant experience, and your contact information. Missing any one of these weakens the document significantly.

Past performance when you are new

New businesses struggle here because they think past performance means government contracts. It does not. It means documented, verifiable experience doing the type of work the contract requires. Owner-operated field service work, pilot operations, internal projects with documented outcomes, and commercial client experience all count as relevant experience when framed correctly. The key is specificity — not 'we do events' but 'planned and executed 12-person crew deployment for a Baltimore catering operation including scheduling, check-in tracking, and same-day completion documentation.'

Live workshop — build yours tonight

Using the FASS playbook as a template, students will populate each section of their own capabilities statement during class. Bring your EIN, your NAICS codes, your business address, and three examples of relevant work you have done — paid or unpaid, commercial or internal.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Complete your capabilities statement draft. It should be one to two pages, include all six sections, and have zero placeholder text remaining. Bring it to Night 5 for peer review.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 4

- ✓ A capabilities statement is the single most important document a government contractor can have
- ✓ Six required sections: company profile, NAICS codes, core competencies, differentiators, past performance, contact
- ✓ New businesses frame pilot operations and commercial experience as relevant experience

- ✓ Specificity beats generality — exact numbers, roles, and outcomes outperform vague claims

NOTES

Capabilities Statement Workshop — Review, Refine, and Make It Submission-Ready

Week 1 · Peer review, instructor feedback, and final polish

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Receive structured feedback on your capabilities statement draft
- Apply the contracting officer's lens — what they look for and what turns them off
- Finalize your capabilities statement to professional standard
- Understand where and how to distribute it

The contracting officer's first read

Contracting officers receive dozens of capabilities statements. They spend 60–90 seconds on the first pass. They are looking for: Does this business do what I need? Are they registered in SAM.gov? Are they the right size and set-aside category? Is this document professional enough to trust? If any answer is unclear in 90 seconds, they move on. Your capabilities statement must answer all four questions before the reader reaches the bottom of the first column.

Common mistakes that kill credibility

Vague language with no specifics. Claiming certifications not yet received. Using the word 'we' without ever defining the team. Listing NAICS codes that do not match the actual work. Messy formatting that signals disorganization. Incorrect or missing UEI. Not verifying SAM.gov status before attaching it. Each of these tells the reader the business is not ready.

Peer review structure

Each student reads a partner's capabilities statement and answers: Can you tell exactly what this company does in one sentence? Are all six sections present and complete? Is the past performance specific and verifiable? Would you feel confident attaching this to an agency inquiry? Feedback is specific and constructive — not 'it looks good' but 'the differentiators section reads too generic; try adding a specific outcome from a real job.'

Where to send it

Agency small business offices — most federal and state agencies have a dedicated small business liaison who accepts capabilities statements. Prime contractor teaming — search SAM.gov for large prime contractors in your NAICS codes who hold Maryland contracts and email their small business or subcontracting office. eMMA profile attachment — upload directly to your vendor profile. Matchmaking events — Maryland PTAC and SBA Maryland host regular procurement matchmaking events where you present your capabilities statement directly to agency buyers.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Send your finalized capabilities statement to one agency small business office or prime contractor subcontracting contact before Night 6. Document who you sent it to and when.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 5

- ✓ Contracting officers spend 60–90 seconds on first read — your document must answer four questions immediately
- ✓ Vague language, unverified certifications, and missing sections are the most common disqualifiers
- ✓ Peer review reveals blind spots your own eyes miss

✓ Distribution targets: agency small business offices, prime contractor subs teams, eMMA profile, matchmaking events

NOTES

WEEK TWO — EXECUTION

NIGHT

6

Reading a Solicitation — Extracting Everything That Matters in Two Hours

Week 2 · The READ step of the FASS R-E-A-D workflow

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Understand the structure of a federal and state solicitation
- Know exactly what to extract from any solicitation within two hours of finding it
- Identify mandatory requirements versus evaluation preferences
- Complete the Opportunity Response Worksheet for a real solicitation

Solicitation anatomy

Every government solicitation has the same basic structure regardless of agency or level. The cover page contains the solicitation number, agency, due date, and set-aside status. Section B or the price schedule shows what you are pricing. Section C or the Statement of Work describes exactly what performance is required. Section L tells you how to prepare your response. Section M tells you how you will be evaluated and scored. Read in this order: cover page, set-aside, due date, SOW, evaluation factors, price schedule, then instructions.

Mandatory versus desirable

Every solicitation has mandatory requirements — things that will disqualify your bid if missing — and desirable factors that improve your score. Mandatory items use the words 'shall,' 'must,' 'required,' and 'will.' Desirable items use 'should,' 'may,' 'preferred,' and 'desirable.' Highlight every 'shall' and 'must' in the solicitation before you write a single word of your response. If you cannot meet every mandatory requirement, do not bid.

The two-hour intake process

Hour one: read the entire solicitation front to back without writing anything. Just read. Hour two: open the Opportunity Response Worksheet and populate every field from memory and re-reference. Solicitation number, agency, due date, submission method, NAICS and set-aside, SOW deliverables, labor categories, quantities, pricing format, evaluation factors, mandatory attachments, amendments. When the worksheet is complete, you have a complete intake. When it is not, you have gaps to resolve before bidding.

Amendments and addenda

Agencies frequently issue amendments — changes to the solicitation after initial posting. Every amendment must be acknowledged in your response, usually by completing an amendment acknowledgement form. Bidders who miss an amendment and fail to acknowledge it are often disqualified on a technicality before evaluation begins. Subscribe to the opportunity in SAM.gov or eMMA so you receive automatic notifications of any changes.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Find one real open solicitation on SAM.gov or eMMA in your NAICS code. Complete the full Opportunity Response Worksheet for it. Bring it to Night 7.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 6

- ✓ Read solicitations in order: cover page → set-aside → due date → SOW → evaluation factors → price schedule → instructions
- ✓ Highlight every 'shall' and 'must' — these are your mandatory requirements and disqualifiers
- ✓ The two-hour intake process produces a completed Opportunity Response Worksheet
- ✓ Always check for amendments and acknowledge every one in your response

NOTES

Bid / No-Bid — The Decision That Saves You From Losing Before You Start

Week 2 · How to evaluate an opportunity and make a same-day decision

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Apply the six bid/no-bid questions to a real solicitation
- Identify the no-go triggers that disqualify a bid before submission
- Calculate whether a contract is worth pursuing based on margin and risk
- Make a confident same-day bid/no-bid decision

Why the bid/no-bid decision is critical

Every proposal you write takes time, focus, and often money. A non-compliant bid wastes all three and has zero chance of winning. The bid/no-bid decision protects your resources and your reputation. The goal is not to respond to every opportunity — it is to respond only to opportunities you can win and execute. One well-executed contract is worth more than ten failed proposals.

The six questions

One: Can FASS legally bid today — is SAM.gov status active if required, do NAICS codes match, are certifications current? Two: Can FASS meet every mandatory technical, staffing, insurance, security, and location requirement? Three: Can FASS source and verify labor, providers, vendors, materials, equipment, and leadership before committing to price? Four: Is there enough time to produce a compliant, well-priced package with all required forms? Five: Does the margin justify the cash-flow exposure, performance risk, and management time? Six: Can FASS substantiate every experience claim, reference, and certification in the response?

The no-go triggers

Do not submit if: you cannot meet a mandatory requirement. You cannot validate your price and staffing. You lack a required credential or certification. You cannot accept the contractual terms. You cannot complete the prescribed submission package by the deadline. One no-go trigger is enough to kill the bid. The discipline is in stopping — not in trying to paper over a gap with vague language.

Scoring margin and risk

Before committing to a bid, estimate: direct labor or provider cost, payroll burden and insurance, project management and oversight, equipment and supplies, contingency, and your fee. If the contract value minus all costs does not produce a margin that justifies the performance period, cash-flow exposure, and management time, it is a no-bid regardless of how attractive the opportunity looks.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Apply all six bid/no-bid questions to the solicitation you found for Night 6. Write your decision — bid, no-bid, or hold for question — with the specific reason for each question. Bring to Night 8.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 7

- ✓ The bid/no-bid decision protects your time, money, and reputation
- ✓ Six questions — all six must clear before you commit
- ✓ One no-go trigger is enough to stop the bid
- ✓ Margin, cash-flow, and management time are financial decisions, not just compliance decisions

NOTES

Pricing Your Bid — Building a Number That Wins Without Losing Money

Week 2 · How to price from verified scope, not guesswork

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Build a price from the bottom up using verified labor, provider, and supply costs
- Understand what payroll burden, fringe, and insurance add to direct labor cost
- Apply the FASS internal pricing bands correctly
- Produce a compliant price schedule for a real solicitation

Price from the scope, not the market

The most common pricing mistake is starting with a number and working backward. The correct method is: read the SOW, identify every deliverable, quantity, labor category, and hour requirement, source your actual costs, add burden and overhead, add margin, then compare to the market. If your cost-built price is not competitive, you either find cost savings or you do not bid. You do not reduce your price below cost and hope to make it up somewhere.

The pricing components

Direct labor or provider cost: labor category times quantity times hours times verified hourly rate. Payroll burden: add taxes, workers compensation, liability insurance, and any required fringe benefits when FASS is the employer of record. Project management and oversight: crew captains, site leads, and reporting staff are separate line items, not absorbed into field labor. Equipment, supplies, consumables: quote actual costs, do not estimate. Vendor and subcontractor cost: attach or retain the actual quotes — do not use ballpark numbers. Mobilization: mileage, parking, after-hours access, any required training or background check costs.

Using the FASS internal price bands

The playbook contains internal bid-planning bands for each labor family — these are ranges built from market research, not guaranteed rates. Program and contract manager: \$55–\$85 per hour. Site lead and crew captain: \$40–\$65. Specialized operations and logistics: \$35–\$55. Food service, event, and guest support: \$30–\$50. General labor, setup, and stocking: \$28–\$45. Janitorial and cleanup: \$28–\$42. These are planning tools only. Final pricing must reflect the actual solicitation requirements, local wage determinations, verified provider quotes, and your actual margin.

Wage determinations and labor clauses

Some federal and state service contracts require paying workers the prevailing wage under the Service Contract Act or state wage laws. If a wage determination is attached to the solicitation, it is not optional — it sets the minimum wage and fringe you must pay for each labor category. Price below it and you are non-compliant. Identify whether a wage determination applies in your intake and price accordingly.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Build a complete bottom-up price for the solicitation you have been tracking. Use the FASS pricing components. Show every line item. Bring the price build to Night 9.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 8

- ✓ Price from the scope up — never from a target number down
- ✓ Every component must appear as a line item: labor, burden, overhead, management, supplies, mobilization
- ✓ Internal price bands are planning tools — final pricing requires verified quotes and wage determinations

- ✓ If the cost-built price is not competitive, find savings or do not bid — never price below cost

NOTES

Writing the Response — Telling Your Story in the Agency's Language

Week 2 · Technical narrative, past performance, and the assembly checklist

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Structure a technical narrative that mirrors the solicitation's evaluation criteria
- Write past performance entries that are specific, verifiable, and relevant
- Assemble a complete proposal package using the Proposal Assembly Checklist
- Avoid the formatting and compliance mistakes that disqualify bids before evaluation

Mirror the solicitation's structure

Evaluators score your response against the solicitation's evaluation criteria, in order. The fastest way to lose points is to answer questions in an order different from the one the evaluator is using. Mirror the solicitation's headings exactly. If Section L says to organize your technical volume as (1) understanding of scope, (2) technical approach, (3) staffing plan, (4) quality plan, then your response has exactly those four sections in exactly that order. Evaluators should be able to read your response with the solicitation open and find every answer exactly where they expect it.

The technical narrative sequence

Standard strong sequence: scope understanding, technical and work plan, staffing and supervision, mobilization and schedule, quality assurance and reporting, past performance and references, pricing, forms and certifications. Under each section, be specific — not 'we will provide qualified staff' but 'FASS will deploy one site lead and four crew associates reporting to the designated COR by 6:45 AM on Day 1, with a pre-task checklist completed and submitted by 7:30 AM.'

Writing past performance entries

Each past performance entry should include: the client or agency name and contact, the contract or project value, the period of performance, a brief description of the scope, the specific outcomes and metrics, and any client feedback or rating. For pilot and commercial operations, use the same format — it signals professionalism and makes your experience easy to evaluate. Vague entries like 'managed various staffing projects' score zero. Specific entries like 'deployed 8-person event crew for Baltimore-area catering operation, achieving 100% attendance and on-time completion with client confirmation on file' score points.

The Proposal Assembly Checklist

The checklist in your playbook is your final quality control before submission. Cover letter with correct solicitation number and authorized signature. Technical narrative mirroring evaluation criteria. Correct pricing form with all quantities and extensions checked. All required agency forms completed and signed. Company data including UEI and active SAM status. Proof of capability including experience, references, and certifications as required. Correct file types, file names, size limits, and submission portal. Receipt saved. A clean response package is a competitive advantage — many bidders lose on a technicality before their technical work is ever evaluated.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Draft the technical narrative for your solicitation. It should mirror the solicitation's evaluation headings. Bring a complete draft to Night 10.

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 9

- ✓ Mirror the solicitation's headings exactly — evaluators score in order

- ✓ Every claim must be specific, quantified, and verifiable — vague language scores zero
- ✓ Past performance entries follow a consistent format: client, value, period, scope, outcome, contact
- ✓ The Proposal Assembly Checklist is your final gate — run it before every submission

NOTES

After the Award — Performing, Documenting, and Using One Contract to Win the Next

Week 2 · From award letter to past performance — how to build the record that compounds

TONIGHT'S OBJECTIVES

- Understand what happens after an award is issued and what your obligations are
- Build the documentation and performance record that makes the next bid stronger
- Learn how subcontracting as an MBE builds past performance without winning a prime
- Map your 90-day post-award execution plan

The award is the beginning, not the end

A contract award is a legal obligation, not just a win. The agency expects you to perform exactly what you proposed, on the schedule you committed to, at the quality level you described. Performance failures on government contracts are documented in CPARS — the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System at the federal level — and equivalent systems at the state level. A poor performance record follows your company and actively hurts future bids. A strong record compounds — contracting officers can see it and it becomes your most powerful differentiator.

The FASS closeout process

Every job under a government contract should follow the FASS execution model: mobilize with confirmed roster and scope, deploy with a crew lead check-in, manage with daily status and quality checks, close out with completion confirmation, time records, and photos where permitted. The closeout package is not just good practice — it is your evidence file if there is ever a dispute, and it becomes the documentation behind your next past performance entry.

Building past performance while waiting for a prime

You do not need to win a prime contract to build government past performance. Subcontracting as a certified MBE under a prime contractor gives you a contract number, a client contact, a period of performance, and a measurable outcome — everything a past performance entry requires. Actively seek teaming arrangements and subcontracting work with prime contractors who hold Maryland service contracts in your NAICS codes. Every subcontract executed well is a past performance entry for your next prime bid.

The compound effect

One contract executed well produces: a past performance entry, a client reference, documented performance metrics, a crew performance record, preferred provider relationships, and the credibility to bid larger contracts. Two or three executed contracts produce a pipeline. Ten produce a track record. The businesses that dominate small business contracting are not smarter or better resourced — they started, executed well, documented everything, and compounded their credibility one job at a time.

TONIGHT'S HOMEWORK

Write your 90-day post-award plan. What is the first contract you realistically target — state, local, or sub? What steps do you take in the next 30 days to be ready to execute the moment an award comes?

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM NIGHT 10

- ✓ Government contracts are legal obligations — performance failures are documented and follow your company
- ✓ Every job deserves the full FASS closeout process: mobilize, deploy, manage, close out with evidence
- ✓ MBE subcontracting builds past performance without winning a prime — pursue it immediately

- ✓ The compound effect of executed contracts is the only sustainable path to large contract wins

NOTES

Reference — Opportunity Response Worksheet

Complete one worksheet per solicitation before drafting any response. One solicitation = one worksheet + one bid/no-bid decision + one controlled response package.

Agency / Buyer	
Solicitation Number	
Title	
Due Date / Time / Timezone	
Submission Portal / Method	
Buyer / CO / POC	
NAICS / PSC / Set-aside	
Contract Type / Period of Performance	

Price Format	
Amendments / Addenda	
Primary deliverable / outcome	
Labor categories / quantity / hours	
Supplies / equipment / vendor needs	
Site / access / safety / security	
Reports / evidence / closeout	

Performance measures / acceptance	
Key risks / assumptions / questions	
Bid / No-Bid Decision	
Response Owner	
Crew / Vendor Confirmations	
Authorized Signatory	
Final Submission Receipt	
Follow-Up Date	

Quick Reference — The FASS R-E-A-D Workflow

Step	Action	Target	What to Produce
R — Read	Extract all intake fields into the Opportunity Response Worksheet	Within 2 hours of finding the opportunity	Completed worksheet with zero blank fields
E — Evaluate	Answer all six bid/no-bid questions. Make a same-day decision.	Same day as intake	Bid / No-Bid decision with reasoning
A — Assemble	Build the technical narrative, staffing plan, price, and forms package	Early draft before final day	Complete draft response package
D — Deliver	Quality control, authorized signature, submit, save receipt	Before deadline	Submission receipt and follow-up task

North Star

FASS does not just respond to solicitations. FASS builds the capacity plan that makes the award executable: people, crews, providers, suppliers, schedule, reporting, evidence, and closeout.